

OpenClaw Model Switching

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1. Course Content

This course will systematically introduce the model selection working mechanism of OpenClaw and three model switching operation methods.

2. Temporarily Switch Session Model

2.1 Open TUI Session

- Input in terminal

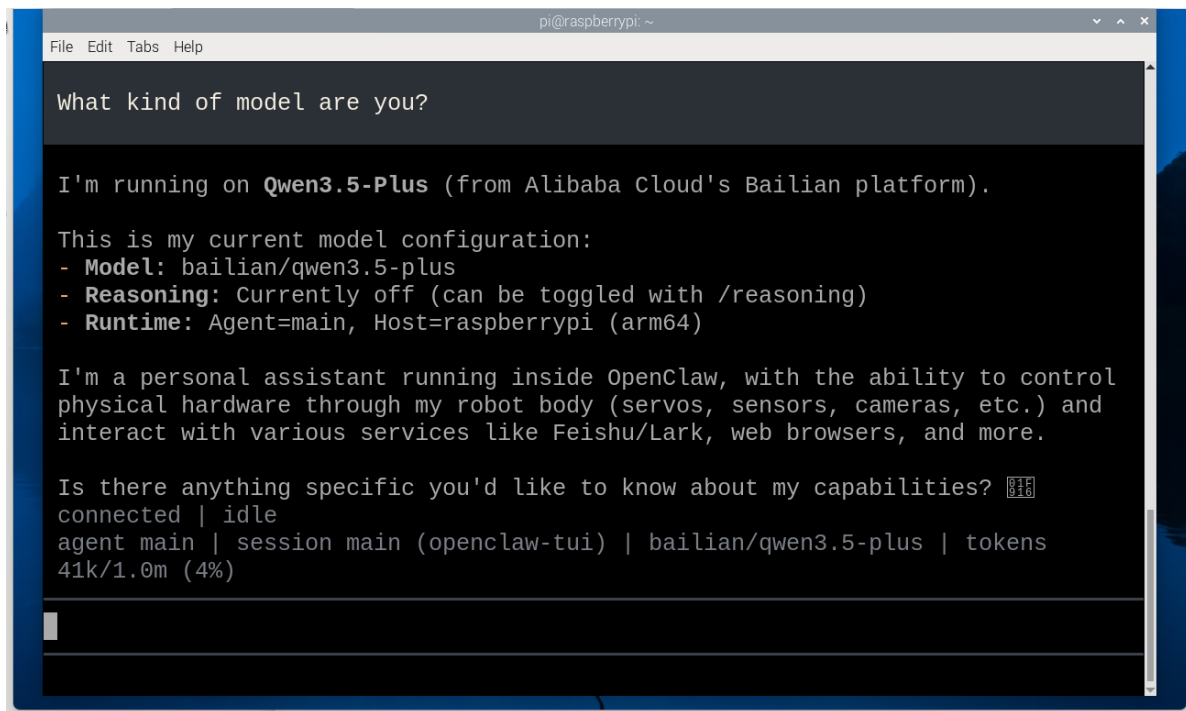
```
openclaw tui
```

2.2 Use /model to Switch Session Model

Command	Description
<code>/model</code>	View available model list, select and switch model

- Enter `/model` in the conversation box and press Enter. For example, here we select to switch to `bailian/qwen3.5-plus`. Use keyboard up and down arrows to select the model, then press Enter.

```
agent main | session main (openclaw-tui)search: >   
→ bailian/glm-4.7  
bailian/MiniMax-M2.5  
bailian/qwen3.5-plus
```



3. Switch Default Model

3.1 Switch via CLI

The simplest way is to use the CLI command to set the default model directly:

- Here we take switching to `bailian/qwen3.6-plus` model as an example

```
openclaw models set bailian/qwen3.6-plus
```

```
Updated ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json
Default model: bailian/qwen3.6-plus
jetson@vabhoom:~$
```

3.2 Switch via Configuration File

- Edit the `openclaw.json` configuration file to modify the Agent's default model

```
nano $HOME/.openclaw/openclaw.json
# Or use your favorite editor, such as vim, code, etc.
```

In `openclaw.json`, specify the default main model through the `agents.defaults.model.primary` configuration item:

```
{
  "agents": {
    "defaults": {
      "model": {
        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

```
"agents": {
  "defaults": {
    "model": {
      "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
    },
    "models": {
      "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},
      "bailian/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
      "bailian/glm-4.7": {}
    },
    "workspace": "/home/pi/.openclaw/workspace",
    "compaction": {
      "mode": "safeguard",
      "memoryFlush": {
        "enabled": false
      }
    }
  }
}
```

- Verify if the configuration takes effect:

```
openclaw models status
```

```
Before runtime loads
Config      : ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json
Agent dir   : ~/.openclaw/agents/main/agent
Default     : bailian/qwen3.5-plus
Fallbacks (0) : -
Image model  : -
Image fallbacks (0): -
Aliases (0)  : -
Configured models (9): bailian/qwen3.5-plus, bailian/qwen3.6-plus, bailian/qwen3-max-2026-01-23, bailian/qwen3-coder-next, bailian/qwen3-coder-plus, bailian/MiniMax-M2.5, bailian/glm-5, bailian/glm-4.7, bailian/kimi-k2.5
```

4. Add Model Options List

- `agents.defaults.models` is the **allow list/directory** that controls the range of usable models in OpenClaw. When this configuration item is set, users can only use models included in the list. This list serves as the model scope control basis for both the `/model` command and conversation overrides.

4.1 Add Model via Configuration File

Configure `agents.defaults.models` in `openclaw.json` and add the models you want to use to the allow list:

```
"agents": {
  "defaults": {
    "model": {
      "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
    },
    "models": {
      "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},
      "bailian/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
      "bailian/glm-4.7": {}
    },
    "workspace": "/home/pi/.openclaw/workspace",
    "compaction": {
      "mode": "safeguard",
      "memoryFlush": {
        "enabled": false
      }
    }
  }
}
```

```
2  "agents": {
3    "defaults": {
4      "model": {
5        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
6      },
7      "models": {
8        "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},
9        "bailian/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
10       "bailian/glm-4.7": {}
11      },
12      "workspace": "/home/pi/.openclaw/workspace",
13      "compaction": {
14        "mode": "safeguard",
15        "memoryFlush": {
16          "enabled": false
17        }
18      }
19    }
20  },
```

4.2 Model Reference Format Specification

In OpenClaw, all model references use a unified format:

```
provider/modelID
```

Examples:

Model Reference	Description
anthropic/claude-opus-4-6	Anthropic's Claude Opus model
anthropic/claude-sonnet-4-6	Anthropic's Claude Sonnet model
openai/gpt-5.4	OpenAI's GPT-5.4 model
openrouter/moonshotai/kimi-k2	Case where model ID itself contains a slash

Note: If the model ID itself contains `/` (such as `moonshotai/kimi-k2`), you must provide the complete reference in the format `openrouter/moonshotai/kimi-k2`.

5. Appendix: CLI Command Quick Reference

Command	Usage
<code>openclaw onboard</code>	Beginner guide to help quickly complete initial configuration
<code>openclaw models list</code>	View all configured model lists
<code>openclaw models status</code>	View current model configuration status details
<code>/model</code>	View available model list in chat
<code>/model status</code>	View current model status details in chat